

B2

GRAMMAR LESSON · WISH & IF ONLY

Wish / If Only + Past Perfect

I wish I had... / If only I hadn't... — regrets about the past.

Geçmişe Yönelik Pişmanlık

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Geçmişte yaptığımız (ya da yapmadığımız) bir şeye pişman olduğumuzda **wish / if only + past perfect (had + V3)** kullanırız. **if only**, wish'in daha duygusal ve vurgulu halidir; genellikle tek başına ünlem gibi de kullanılabilir. Bu yapı, değiştiremeyeceğimiz geçmiş bir durumu anlatır.

The Structure

Formula

I wish / If only + S + had (not) + V3

Olumlu geçmiş olay için pişmanlık → had + V3 olumsuz şeklinde kurulur çünkü aslında "keşke olmasaydı" demektir.

Olumsuz/eksik bir geçmiş olay için pişmanlık → had + V3 olumlu şeklinde kurulur çünkü "keşke olsaydı" demektir.

If only! (tek başına, güçlü bir iç çekiş/pişmanlık ünlemi)

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE

I wish + S + had + V3

I wish I had saved more money.

NEGATIVE

I wish + S + hadn't + V3

I wish I hadn't lied to him.

QUESTION

Do you wish + S + had + V3?

Do you wish you had traveled more when you were young?

Word Order

Özne — wish/if only — (that, genelde düşer) — özne — had (not) — V3

- I **wish** I **had listened** to my parents. — Keşke ailemi dinleseydim.
- **If only** we **hadn't missed** the flight. — Keşke uçağı kaçırmasaydık.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **wish + past perfect**: kendi geçmiş bir hatana/kararına pişmanlık için. I wish I had studied medicine.
- **if only + past perfect**: aynı anlam ama daha güçlü, daha duygusal bir vurgu taşır, sık sık tek başına ünlem cümlesi olarak kullanılır. If only I had listened to her advice!
- **başkasının geçmişteki davranışına pişmanlık/şikayet**: I wish you had told me the truth earlier.
- **geçmişte olan bir şeyin olmamasını dilemek** (olumsuz past perfect ile): I wish it hadn't rained on our wedding day.

When DON'T we use it?

geçmişe pişmanlık için past simple KULLANMA: past simple, şimdiki zamana yönelik dilek anlatır; geçmiş bir olay için past perfect gerekir.

✗ I wish I knew the answer yesterday. → ✓ I wish I had known the answer yesterday.

wish/if only'dan sonra "would have" KULLANMA: geçmişe pişmanlıkta doğru yapı had + V3'tür, would have değildir (would have, kendi cümlesinde farklı bir anlam taşır ve wish ile birleşmez).

✗ I wish I would have known. → ✓ I wish I had known.

Short Answers

Hızlı kural: geçmişe pişmanlık = wish/if only + had (not) + V3. Şimdiye pişmanlık = wish + past simple/could (bkz. Wish + Present/Future dersi). "would have" wish ile birlikte KULLANILMAZ.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Keşke o işi kabul etmeseydim." → NE ZAMAN OLDU? → Geçmişte (iş kabul edildi, artık değiştirilemez) → İNGİLİZCEDE HANGİ YAPI? → wish + past perfect (had + V3), gerçeğin tersini anlatır → CÜMLE → "I wish I hadn't accepted that job."

Examples

TEMEL: KENDİ PİŞMANLIĞIN

- I wish I had taken that job offer. — Keşke o iş teklifini kabul etseydim.
- I wish I hadn't spent all my savings on that car. — Keşke tüm birikimimi o arabaya harcamasaydım.
- She wishes she had finished university. — Keşke üniversiteyi bitirseydi.
- We wish we had booked the tickets earlier. — Keşke biletleri daha erken almış olsaydık.

IF ONLY (VURGU)

- If only I had checked the weather forecast before we left! — Keşke gitmeden önce hava durumuna baksaydım!
- If only she had told me about the meeting! — Keşke bana toplantıdan bahsetseydi!
- If only! — Keşke! (tek başına, iç çekerek söylenen bir cümle)

BAŞKASINA/DURUMA ŞİKAYET

- I wish you had called before coming over. — Keşke gelmeden önce arasaydın.
- I wish it hadn't rained during our trip. — Keşke gezimiz sırasında yağmur yağmasaydı.
- He wishes his father had been stricter with him as a child. — Keşke babası çocukken ona daha katı davranırdı.
- I wish they hadn't cancelled the concert. — Keşke konseri iptal etmeselerdi.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

Wish + Past Perfect (bu ders)

Geçmişte yaşanmış/yaşanmamış bir olaya pişmanlığı anlatır, artık değiştirilemez.

I wish I had known the truth back then.

Wish + Past Simple

Şimdiki gerçek durumdan farklı bir dilek anlatır.

I wish I knew the truth right now.

→ Wish + Present/Future dersine git

Visual Timeline

Timeline: geçmişte olan/olmayan olay · wish/if only + had (not) + V3 → şimdiden bakarak pişmanlık · artık değiştirilemez

Common Mistakes

✗ I wish I knew the answer yesterday.

✓ I wish I had known the answer yesterday.

WHY? "yesterday" gibi geçmiş bir zaman belirtici varsa past simple değil past perfect kullanılmalıdır.

✗ I wish I would have studied harder for the exam.

✓ I wish I had studied harder for the exam.

WHY? geçmişte pişmanlıkta doğru yapı had + V3'tür; "would have" konuşma dilinde sık duyulsa da dilbilgisi açısından yanlış kabul edilir.

✗ If only I studied abroad when I was young!

✓ If only I had studied abroad when I was young!

WHY? if only da wish gibi geçmiş pişmanlık için past perfect ister, past simple değil.

✗ I wish I hadn't have missed the bus.

✓ I wish I hadn't missed the bus.

WHY? past perfect zaten "had + V3" ile kurulur; olumsuzda bir kez daha "have" eklemek (hadn't have) gereksiz ve yanlıştır.

✗ If only I would know what happened.

✓ If only I knew what happened.

WHY? "what happened" şu anda bilmediğimiz bir şeydir, yani ŞİMDİKİ zamana ait bir dilektir — bu yüzden past perfect değil past simple kullanılır (bkz. Wish + Present/Future dersi).

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 21

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. Find the mistake and correct it.

I wish I ^A knew ^B the answer yesterday. ^C

Correction: _____

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

I wish I ^A would have studied ^B harder. ^C

Correction: _____

3. If only I _____ her advice!

a) had listened to

b) would listen

c) listened

d) have listened

PART B · PRACTICE

4. Find the mistake and correct it.

I wish I ^A hadn't have missed ^B the bus. ^C

Correction: _____

5. I wish you _____ me the truth earlier.

a) have told

b) would tell

c) had told

d) told

6. If only I _____ (not / say) that!

7. I wish I _____ medicine. I'd be a doctor now.

a) would study

b) had studied

c) study

d) studied

8. You didn't buy the flat when it was cheap. Now it's very expensive.

What do you say?

a) I wish I would buy it.

b) I wish I had bought it.

c) I wish I bought it yesterday.

d) I wish I have bought it.

9. "I wish I hadn't eaten so much." What happened?

a) I didn't eat much.

b) I want to eat more.

c) I ate a lot and I regret it.

d) I'll eat a lot tomorrow.

10. She wishes she _____ to the party. It sounds like it was fun.

a) had gone

b) goes

c) would go

d) went

11. Which sentence is about the present?

a) I wish I lived near the sea.

b) If only I had lived near the sea.

c) I wish I hadn't moved.

d) I wish I had lived near the sea.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. I wish I _____ harder at school.

- a) work b) worked c) would have work d) had worked

13. If only we _____ earlier! We missed the start.

- a) left b) would leave c) leave d) had left

14. He wishes he _____ (take) the job offer.

15. Find the mistake and correct it.

If only I ^A studied ^B abroad when I was young! ^C

Correction: _____

16. I wish it _____ raining yesterday.

- a) isn't b) wouldn't c) wasn't d) hadn't been

17. You forgot your best friend's birthday last week.

What do you say?

- a) I wish I didn't forget your birthday.
b) I wish I haven't forgotten your birthday.
c) I wish I hadn't forgotten your birthday.
d) I wish I wouldn't forget your birthday.

18. "If only I had known!" What does the speaker feel?

- a) Happiness
b) Hope for the future
c) Surprise about now
d) Strong regret about not knowing something in the past

19. They wish they _____ that old car. It keeps breaking down.

- a) wouldn't buy b) hadn't bought c) don't buy d) didn't buy

20. Which sentence is correct?

- a) I wish I have brought my camera.
b) I wish I had brought my camera.
c) I wish I brought my camera yesterday.
d) I wish I would had brought my camera.

21. Rewrite with "I wish": "I'm sorry I didn't call you."

I wish I _____ you.

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **B — knew → had known** — Geçmiş → had + V3.
2. **B — would have studied → had studied** — wish + past perfect.
3. **a) had listened to** — if only + past perfect.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **B — hadn't have missed → hadn't missed** — hadn't + V3.
5. **c) had told** — Geçmişteki davranış → had told.
6. **hadn't said / had not said** — if only + hadn't + V3.
7. **b) had studied** — Geçmiş seçim → had studied.
8. **b) I wish I had bought it.** — Geçmiş pişmanlık → had + V3.
9. **c) I ate a lot and I regret it.** — hadn't + V3 → yaptım, pişmanım.
10. **a) had gone** — Geçmiş → had gone.
11. **a) I wish I lived near the sea.** — wish + past simple → şimdi.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. **d) had worked** — wish + past perfect.
13. **d) had left** — if only + past perfect.
14. **had taken** — had + V3.
15. **B — studied → had studied** — Geçmiş → past perfect.
16. **d) hadn't been** — Geçmiş → hadn't been.
17. **c) I wish I hadn't forgotten your birthday.** — Geçmiş → hadn't + V3.
18. **d) Strong regret about not knowing something in the past** — if only + past perfect → güçlü pişmanlık.
19. **b) hadn't bought** — Geçmiş satın alma → hadn't bought.
20. **b) I wish I had brought my camera.** — wish + had + V3.
21. **I wish I had called you.** — wish + had + V3.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırma):
<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b2/wish-and-if-only-past>